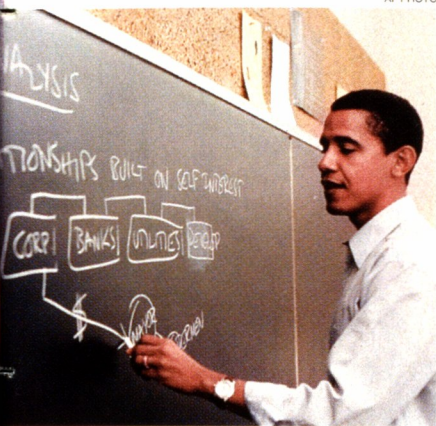




AP PHOTO

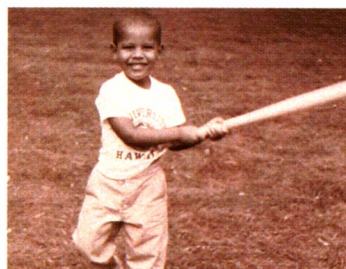
TEACHING AT THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO; (BELOW) WITH MOTHER ANN DUNHAM



REUTERS



AP PHOTO



OBAMA, 10, WITH HIS FATHER, ALSO NAMED BARACK OBAMA (TOP); SWINGING A BAT (ABOVE) AND WITH BRIDE MICHELLE ROBINSON



AP PHOTO

The Rise of Obama

AUGUST 4, 1961: Born in Honolulu, Hawaii, to Barack Obama Sr and Stanley Ann Dunham Obama

1990: Becomes the first African-American president of the Harvard Law Review

1997-2004: Served in Illinois State Senate

MARCH 21, 2000: Loses Democratic nomination to US Congress to incumbent Bobby L. Rush

MARCH 16, 2004: Wins Democratic seat to the US Congress

JULY 27, 2004: Delivers speech at the Democratic National Convention, secures place as a rising star

NOV 2, 2004: Becomes one of the youngest members of the US Senate

FEBRUARY 10, 2007: Announces his candidacy for the President of the United States in the 2008 US presidential election

JUNE 3, 2008: After defeating Senator Hillary Clinton in the primaries, he becomes the presumptive nominee of the Democratic Party

NOVEMBER 5, 2008: Wins the US Presidential Election and becomes the first African-American President of the United States

of a more perfect union. For the African American community, that path means embracing the burdens of our past without becoming victims of our past. It means continuing to insist on a full measure of justice in every aspect of American life. But it also means binding our particular grievances to the larger aspirations of all Americans." He didn't run for the presidency as an aggrieved Black American but as a candidate for all Americans. As Colin Powell said, a "transformational" figure.

His biography added legitimacy to the sociology of transformation. His biracial origin has made him the ideal

candidate of unity. An absentee father may not have created a void in his adolescence years, thanks to Gramps and Toot (that's how he called his White maternal grandparents). "At the time of his death (in a car accident in Nairobi), my father remained a myth to me, both more and less than a man. He had left Hawaii back in 1963, when I was only two years old, so that as a child I knew him only through the stories that my mother and grandparents told. They all had their favourites, each one seamless, burnished smooth from repeated use", he wrote in his first book of memoir, *Dreams from My Father*. This ac-

quired mythology of his father didn't provide him with a role model; it nevertheless gave him an ancestral memory that defied frontiers. When his mother, an embodiment of wanderlust, moved to Jakarta to live with his Indonesian stepfather, Obama as a boy for the first time experienced the reality of a world beyond America. He lived multiculturalism, and saw the ghettos of dispossession beyond American affluence. There was another world, and that world continues to shape his outlook. There would have been no Obama the compassionate internationalist without the back alleys of Third World